



Colorado State Committee Meeting – July 23, 2026

Executive Session Minutes

Meeting Place:	Via TEAMS
Members Present:	Don Brown, Chairperson Kyle McConnell, Member Steve Raftopoulos, Member Joe Petrocco, Member Darrell Mackey, Member
Staff Present:	Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist Woody Woods, District Director Scott Brase, District Director Sam Montoya, District Director
Guests:	None

1. Call to Order

The Colorado State Committee (STC) met on July 23, 2026, via TEAMS. Don Brown, State Committee Chairperson opened the Executive Session at 10:50 a.m.

2. Approve Executive Session Minutes

A June 25, 2026, Minutes

The STC reviewed the Executive Session minutes from the June 25, 2026, meeting. After reviewing the minutes, Darrell Mackey made a motion to approve the minutes as presented. Joe Petrocco seconded the motion. Motion passed.

3. Conservation Reserve Program (CRP)

A FY22 CRP Cost Share Component Rate Increase Request

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 1 to review and make a determination if a request to increase FY2022 cost share rate on cost share component COCRP6577 (Water Well: 300-600 Feet) should be recommended to DAFP.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation in Exhibit 1, the STC determined to table this action. Staff to provide STC with a list of cost items that were included and considered for drilling a well 300-600 ft when the 2022PY rate was approved by STC.

4. Emergency Conservation Program (ECP)

A ECP Application Review- Rio Blanco County – Eleanor Carter

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 2 to review and make a determination on the ECP application submitted by the Rio Blanco County Committee for Rio Blanco, County producer Eleanor Carter.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 2), Steve Raftopoulos moved to recommend the ECP-PM approve the ECP application for Rio Blanco County producer Eleanor Carter. Kyle McConnell seconded the motion. Motion Passed.

B ECP Application Review- Rio Blanco County – Mike Lopez

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 3 to review and make a determination on the ECP application submitted by the Rio Blanco County Committee for Rio Blanco, County producer Mike Lopez.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 3), Steve Raftopoulos moved to recommend the ECP-PM approve the ECP application for Rio Blanco County producer Mike Lopez. Kyle McConnell seconded the motion. Motion Passed.

5. Noninsured Crop Disaster Assistance Program (NAP)

A Set a guide or standard on forage crop pricing

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the information in Exhibit 4 to review and request recommendations from the STC on standards that can be followed in the future for setting prices for various forage crops allowing them to be more consistent and accurate.

STC reviewed the information in Exhibit 4. STC discussed what forage crops tend to be priced higher due to various reasons including but not limited to nutritional value, type of livestock and age of livestock being fed. STC to provide suggestions that will be presented at the next STC meeting.

B 2027 NCT Colorado Review (Apples; Apricots; Cherries; Garlic; Grapes; Honey; Hops; Peaches; Pears; Triticale)

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the information in Exhibits 5-14 (Crops listed above) to review and make a determination on County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP).

After having a lengthy discussion on policy including explanations from staff about the NCT software, what the STO actually adds into the software and how the CEY is currently being calculated and recommended, the STC moved to table all 2027 crop reviews. SED to provide additional information on how other states set their CEY.

C New Crop Request

1) Las Animas - Beans - pinto (PNT) with the intended use of dry edible (De) and a practice of irrigated (Ir)

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 15 to review and make a determination on a new irrigated (Ir) practice for Beans - pinto (PNT) with the intended use of dry edible (De) to be added as a NAP covered commodity for 2026 and succeeding years in Las Animas County.

STC determined the crop is not an experimental crop for Las Animas County.

2026 STO Approved NCT Data.

PP Factor	UH Factor	Certified Organic Factor	Transitional Organic Factor	Final Planting Date	Normal Harvest Date	Application Closing Date
0.63 ¹	0.80	0.65 ¹	0.65 ¹	06/20	10/31	03/15

¹/Different than the COC request – was previously set for the State.

	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Yield	1079	1079	1079	1179	1179

Rounded to the whole pound.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 15), Kyle McConnell moved to approve the Las Animas County's request to add a new irrigated (Ir) practice for Beans - pinto (PNT) with the intended use of dry edible (De) as a NAP covered commodity for 2026 and succeeding years in Las Animas County as presented, and recommended by the STO and shown above. Steve Raftopoulos seconded the motion. Motion passed.

2) NCT – COC Concern – Montezuma

Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief, presented the STC with policy and information in Exhibit 17 to review concerning the NAP National Crop Table. Montezuma COC submitted a memo to the STC regarding NCT County Expected Yields (CEY) trends for NAP covered crops within their counties over the past few years.

After reviewing the documentation in Exhibit 17, the STC instructed the SED to send a memo to the Montezuma COC acknowledging the STC received their memo and that the STC is currently looking into how NCT works and how County Expected Yields are set.

6. Adjournment

There being no further business, Joe Petrocco moved to adjourn the Executive Session. Kyle McConnell seconded motion. Motion passed. Executive Session was adjourned at 12:45 p.m. The next meeting is scheduled for August 27, 2026, in person and via TEAMs.

Approved:

State Committee Chairperson

Date

State Executive Director

Date

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